

Publication, Authorship and Data and Instruments Licence Policy

The Hackles Kit

Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell.

FIELD COPY



PLATE I. The six strands, hand-inked, in the order the lessons take them.

A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org

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OCTOBER 2026

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A policy a research partner can sign. It keeps the owner's intellectual property intact, protects researchers' independence, and sets plain rules for authorship, data and instruments. It is a draft for counsel to review before anyone relies on it [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]. It is not legal advice. Hackles has not been evaluated in a controlled trial and has not been approved by any agency.

No student accounts, no student data collected, ever.

01 Purpose and parties

THIS POLICY APPLIES TO researchers at colleges and other institutions ("the Researchers") who study Hackles teaching or the College Edition course, and to Competence Collective ("the Owner"), which owns and publishes the Hackles kit. It sets expectations before work starts. Each study should attach a one-page agreement that cites this policy [INSTITUTION and OWNER to sign].

02 What the Owner owns, and what the Researchers own

ITEM	OWNER OF THE RIGHTS	TERMS
Hackles lesson text, teaching materials, the Teacher Academy, the Concepts Lab, the Facilitator Kit, the Assessment Pack surveys and rubrics, and this College Edition	Competence Collective	CC BY-NC 4.0: free to print, share and adapt for non-commercial use with credit
The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork	Competence Collective	Not covered by that license. Print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use. Any other use needs written permission
The Researchers' study design, preregistration, analysis code and manuscripts	The Researchers and their institution	Their own; may carry any license they choose, except that they may not claim ownership of Owner materials quoted or reproduced inside them
Data the Researchers collect	The Researchers and their institution, subject to participant consent, IRB terms and privacy law	See Section 6
Adaptations of Owner instruments	Adapter owns only the new material; the Owner keeps rights in the original text	Must be labeled "adapted from the Hackles Assessment Pack" and carry the same CC BY-NC 4.0 notice

03 Using the Hackles name and materials in publications

- **Naming the curriculum.** Researchers may refer to "Hackles" and "the Hackles Assessment Pack" by name to describe what they studied, accurately and without implying endorsement [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM; the HACKLES trademark has not been cleared, and the kit's Round 1 check did not attempt trademark clearance].
- **No logos or artwork** in papers, posters or slides without written permission, except unaltered use in classroom or family materials the study describes.
- **No implied approval.** Do not say or imply that Hackles has been evaluated, validated, certified, approved or endorsed by any agency, school district, funder or the Owner. The Owner has not endorsed any study unless it says so in writing.
- **Credit line.** Reproduce the notice from any Owner material you quote: "© 2026 Competence Collective. Lesson text and teaching materials CC BY-NC 4.0. The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork are not covered by that license: print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use; any other use needs written permission. [VERIFY with counsel]"
- **Honest status statement.** Every publication, preregistration and IRB protocol states that no controlled trial of Hackles had been completed before the study [VERIFY at the time of writing], and uses the limits statement template.

04 Independence and the courtesy review

- **Right to publish.** Researchers decide what to report, including null, negative and unwelcome results. The Owner has no veto over findings, interpretation or conclusions.
- **Courtesy review.** Researchers offer the Owner the manuscript, poster or report at least **30 days** before submission, **only** to check (a) factual descriptions of the kit, (b) correct use of the Owner's name, credit lines and materials, and (c) that no Owner IP is misused. The Owner may suggest corrections of fact. The Researchers decide what to change. The Owner may not require changes to results or conclusions. If the Owner does not reply within 30 days, the Researchers may proceed.
- **Funding and conflicts.** Researchers declare any funding or link to the Owner. The Owner discloses any funding or role it provided. If the Owner or an affiliated person wishes to be an author, see Section 5.

- **Independent analysis.** If an author is affiliated with the Owner, an independent person on the team runs and checks the primary analysis, and the analysis plan is preregistered before data are seen.
- **No payment for results.** No one is paid, or promised anything, contingent on a favorable result.

05 **Authorship**

- **Criteria.** Authorship follows widely used criteria: a substantial contribution to the design, data or analysis; drafting or critically revising the work; approval of the final version; and accountability for the work [VERIFY: the ICMJE recommendations, or the CRediT contributor roles, as your institution prefers]. Everyone who meets the criteria is invited to be an author, and everyone listed meets them.
- **Order.** Agree author order, corresponding author and acknowledgments in writing **before data collection**, and revisit if roles change. Disputes go to a neutral senior colleague or the institution's research integrity office.
- **Students as authors.** Candidates and graduate students who contribute substantially may be authors. Do not require students to contribute data or authorship as a course requirement or in return for a grade.
- **Teachers and counselors.** Teachers who contribute to design or interpretation may be authors. Others, including mentor teachers, site hosts, the counselor partner and the independent data custodian, are acknowledged by role with their permission.
- **Competence Collective.** The Owner is acknowledged as the source of the kit. If staff meet the criteria, they may be authors, with a declared conflict.
- **Participants.** No participant is named. Schools and teachers are not named unless they agree in writing.
- **Use of generative AI.** Authors are responsible for every claim. AI tools are not authors. Disclose any use in the methods or acknowledgments, in line with the journal's policy. Never enter participant data or study records into an AI tool.

06 **Data licence and sharing**

Principles. Privacy comes first. Data that could identify a student, a teacher or a small class are never shared.

DATA TYPE	SHARING RULE
Aggregate class tallies (counts only, with study codes, suppression of groups under 10 [VERIFY district rule])	May be shared in a public repository after IRB and school agreement. Recommended license: CC BY-NC 4.0 with attribution to the Researchers. Because the files contain Owner instrument wording or item labels, they also carry the Owner's CC BY-NC 4.0

DATA TYPE	SHARING RULE
	notice
Adult survey data (candidates, teachers)	Share only de-identified, aggregated or coarsened data, and only if the consent form says so. Otherwise share a synthetic or summary dataset
Student-level data (only if the protocol allowed it)	Do not share publicly. Offer a restricted-access process through the institution's data governance, if consent and law allow [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]
Qualitative transcripts	Do not share raw transcripts. Share the codebook and anonymized excerpts approved by the participants
Analysis code and synthetic data	Share freely under a permissive or CC BY-NC license of the Researchers' choice

Terms that travel with the data.

- Attribution to the Researchers and the Owner's notice.
- **Non-commercial use only** for any file containing Owner instrument wording.
- No attempt to re-identify any participant, class, teacher or school. Anyone who receives the data agrees to that.
- Users may not use the data or instruments to build a competing commercial product from Owner materials without written permission [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM].
- Researchers keep the right to use their own data in their own work.

Retention. Follow the IRB-approved data management plan. Keep the minimum for the minimum time.

07 Instruments licence

- The Hackles Assessment Pack surveys, rubrics and tally sheets, and the Teacher Academy surveys and rubrics, are licensed **CC BY-NC 4.0**. Researchers may use them for non-commercial research with credit.
- **Use them unaltered where you can.** Altering wording, response options or scoring changes what the instrument measures and breaks comparability. If you must change an item, record each change and label the version "adapted from the Hackles Assessment Pack."
- **Do not describe the instruments as validated.** The kit reports no reliability or validity evidence. Report any psychometrics you compute as descriptions of your own data, and state their limits.
- **Share the version you used** with your publication, with the license notice, so others can replicate.
- **Commercial use** of the instruments (for example, selling a testing product built on them) needs the Owner's written permission.
- The Owner may update the kit. State the version and date you used.

08 **Publicity, funding and public claims**

- Press releases, social posts and grant materials follow the same honesty rules: no claims of effectiveness, approval or prevention.
- Do not use children's images, student work or school names. Do not quote any child.
- Funders may be named. A funder's logo may not appear next to the Hackles name in a way that implies endorsement.

09 **Ethics and law**

- Every study has IRB review or a documented IRB determination before data collection.
- Researchers follow FERPA, PPRA, COPPA and state laws as counsel advises (see the checklist) [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM].
- Researchers who are mandated reporters know their duty and say in consent forms that confidentiality has limits.
- Researchers follow the Disclosure and Incident Guide if a child tells them something hard.

10 **Changes, disputes and ending**

- This policy may be updated; the version in effect at the start of the study applies unless both parties agree otherwise in writing.
- Disputes: talk first; then involve the institution's research integrity office or a neutral mediator.
- Either party may end the arrangement with written notice. Data already collected remain subject to the consent forms and the IRB plan. Published work stays published; the Owner's license for materials already used remains in force under CC BY-NC 4.0.

11 One-page agreement (sign-off sheet)

Study title and IRB number

Researchers and institution

Owner contact

[CONTACT: to be added]

We agree to follow this policy (version/date)

Courtesy review contact and 30-day window agreed

Authorship and order agreed on (date)

Data to be shared, under what license, and where

Conflicts of interest declared

Signatures and dates

This policy is a draft for counsel's review and is not legal advice.